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government's tax network had a shaky start.

In his second term, Modi has moved with speed and decisiveness, implementing a flurry of changes from lower corporate tax rates and bank reforms to universal health insurance. Though he had to roll back his most ambitious (and controversial) reforms—the farm laws—in November, it was in 2021 that his government brought about major policy change, in the form of a determined push for PSU privatisation. However, given the pushback his sweeping agriculture reforms saw, the Centre is likely to face a landmine of resistance from trade unions and the opposition. Nevertheless, the ball has been set rolling and made 2021 a unique year for central reforms under Modi.

Heralding the government's push for reform was Union Budget 2021-22, in which finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman announced the Centre's plans to give up state control over PSUs through a strategy comprising disinvestment, privatisation and asset monetisation. The Centre set a target of Rs 1.75 lakh crore in revenues from disinvestment in 2021-22, including from the privatisation of two public sector banks and a general insurance company. It succeeded in pushing through the divestment of Air India, a task that several past governments had grappled with. Officials at the PMO (prime minister's office) say that this sets the template for other divestments. Tuhin Kanta Pandey, secretary of